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JOB MANAGEMENT

Version 3.5.2

Product Guide



FRONTISPIECE

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This manual relates to:

Job Management Version 3.5.2

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Glossary



Glossary

Accounts Payable

Costs attributed to outside sources such as sub-contractor costs, bought out materials and services, can be entered into the Job Management system via Accounts Payable. This occurs when the invoice is accepted into the Accounts Payable system by a request for additional information, such as job/sub-job/task, plus a breakdown of the type of expense. Employee expenses can also be entered through Accounts Payable.

Accounts Receivable

Job Management shares customer detail information with Accounts Receivable. Open items are created and relevant accounts are updated on printing of invoices.

Accounts Receivable is a prerequisite to the running of Job Management. This is because every job header must have a customer specified. This must be a customer set up in Accounts Receivable.

Activity

Activities have two main purposes:

1. Reporting/analysis purposes. You can attach any number of activities to a job detail, so that you can subsequently report on all job details that, for example, involved a site visit, or all those which have been invoiced.
2. Processing based on completion of activity. You can attach an activity (or more than one) to a stage payment, so that a stage payment is processed when the activity is complete.

Take the Job Detail Activities option to assign any number of activities to a job detail. Each activity will have a start and completion date entered, and text with it.

From there, you can to link an activity to a stage payment, or you can enter the Stage Payments option to link a payment to any number of activities.

AFI

Also known as the Advanced Financial Integrator, the AFI is designed to take specified codes from a module and to use these codes to create General Ledger account codes for posting.

The AFI interfaces with several JBA modules, and works in a similar way to the Job Management masking.

Advanced Financial Integrator

Also known as the AFI, this module is designed to take specified codes from a module and to use these codes to create General Ledger account codes for posting.

The AFI interfaces with several JBA modules, and works in a similar way to the Job Management masking.

Advanced Order Entry

Also known as AOE, this is an advanced version of Sales Order Processing (SOP), which takes customer orders and processes them.

Analysis Code

Within Job Management, you can record up to eight analysis codes against a job, enabling flexible analysis across jobs.

Asset

Job Management enables you to create fixed assets, and to record them within the Fixed Assets module, if this is linked.

Asset Group

Any job detail with a fixed asset must specify a depreciation rate for that asset. If you wish to specify a detailed depreciation pattern (that is, more detailed than the single flat rate you can enter against the job detail) you must set up an asset group.

Once set up, the group can be specified against as many job details as you wish.

Budget

The system provides for multiple budgets and forecasts at any job level, although if you want a simple set-up you can use one budget code for all jobs, and simply define different figures for each job.

The budget codes and forecasts which you set up can be used not only in preparing budgets and forecasts, but in reports and enquiries. A budget or forecast is identified by its code plus its type (either budget or forecast). The same code can thus be used for both a forecast and a budget.

Budgets can be set at any job level. The module will automatically roll up budgets from a lower level through the job hierarchy. You can record a rolled-up budget at a higher level and then protect it from being overwritten during the automatic roll-up.

Budgets can also be produced against an expense type at each job level, with six budget levels created within any one budget code:

Job level

Sub-job level

Task level

Job / expenses level

Sub-job / expenses level

Task / expenses level

Capitalisation

A purchase can either be recorded in the balance sheet as an asset or in P&L as an expense. If it recorded as an asset, this is called capitalisation.

Charge Code

Charge codes can further breakdown entries against direct transactions (including standing costs), timesheets and employee expenses. These could include items such as hotel bills, travel time, bank holiday, sickness etc. Charge codes are specified at transactional level.

Committed Cost

A committed cost is where a purchase order has been printed but not yet matched to a supplier invoice, or where an inventory item has been requested but not yet despatched.

Cost

Cost transactions are entered against a job by specifying the main job, the sub-job and task (if required), plus the expense type. Costs and income are rolled up (that is, transferred) to the next level. The system will hold this level costs and income, as well as the rolled-up costs, so that main job and sub-jobs show values of work carried out both at that level and at all subordinate levels.

Currency

A job detail can be invoiced in any currency set up on the system. The base currency is the default.

Customer

Every job header must have a customer specified. This must be a customer set up in Accounts Receivable.

Customer Returns

Job Management allows access to the Customer Return functions of adding or amending a return and of receiving a return. This lets you link returns to a job.

Delivery Address

Every job must have a customer with a delivery address which is defined in Accounts Receivable.

Division

Division codes are used within Job Management to identify the division within the company which will be responsible for carrying out work on jobs. Specified at job detail level only.

Employee

Each employee in a job needs to be set up as a parameter. The required data includes employee number and grade.

Employees have to be set up in order to capture timesheet and employee expense details. A claim rate and charge rate are used for company mileage calculations. Labour related rates are associated with an employee grade.

Employee Expenses

Employee expenses may be entered either from within Job Management, or from Accounts Payable. If entered from Accounts Payable, the transactions are posted to Job Management when the invoice is accepted. The employee mileage and claim amount to be charged can be automatically calculated against a job, as required.

Employee Grade

A grade code is defined together with a cost rate per hour and an income rate per hour. Up to eight cost and income rates can be recorded for a grade. Each employee has an associated grade code.

These are specified at employee level. Job Management uses the grades associated with an employee to calculate both cost and income values against

timesheet entries. Details about grade codes are stored with their associated cost and income rates.

Expense Type

All cost transactions entered against a job must have an associated expense type. Expense type transactions would typically include materials, labour, consultancy etc.

The expense types that are relevant for a particular job type are set up within the job types parameter option. Each timesheet, employee expenses and Inventory transaction has a default expense type attributed to it.

Costs are analysed at each level by expense type, giving a very flexible method of analysing costs.

Fixed Assets

The interface to Fixed Assets enables fixed assets to be held against more than one job detail. Where projects using Job Management involve the construction or assembly of fixed assets, the transfer of the asset from Job Management to Fixed Assets can be completed via a transfer facility within Job Management.

Fixed Price

Every job detail must have a price type defined to it. There are three price types:

Fixed price

Time and materials

Non-chargeable.

Fixed price job details can have invoices generated for them, either via the Sundry Invoices / Credit Notes option or on payment of a stage payment (which may be triggered by the completion of an activity).

Forecast

This functions in exactly the same way as a budget.

The system provides for multiple budgets and forecasts at any job level, although if you want a simple set-up you can use one budget code for all jobs, and simply define different figures for each job.

The budget codes and forecasts set up can be used in preparing budgets and forecasts and in reports and enquiries. The same code can be used for both a forecast and a budget. Therefore, a budget or forecast is identified by its code and type.

The system attaches budgeted costs at every level, with a breakdown of year and period. A budget type identifies whether the values are associated with budget or forecast costs.

Budgets can be set at any job level. The module will automatically roll up budgets from a lower level through the job hierarchy. For greater flexibility, it is possible to record a rolled-up budget at a higher level - and then protect it from being overwritten during the automatic roll-up.

Budgets can also be produced against an expense type at each job level, with six budget levels created within any one budget code.

Job level

Sub-job level

Task level

Job/expenses level

Sub-job/expenses level

Task/expenses level.

General Ledger

Detailed cost and income values are held in the Job Management system while a financial summary of job values is provided in the General Ledger (GL).

Obviously, it is imperative that the two sets of values are balanced and can be reconciled.

A Job Management sub-ledger can be set up within the General Ledger with its own control account for work in progress control, as well as other holding accounts for costs entered within Job Management, Inventory Management and Accounts Payable. This is optional.

Each transaction (cost or income) is posted to a valid General Ledger account which must already be set up. Posting masks enable you to target a GL account without having to enter a code on every transaction.

General Ledger is a prerequisite to the running of Job Management.

Industry Code

Each job can hold the industry code of the customer for whom the work is being carried out. It is then possible to analyse across jobs on work carried out on a specific industry. The codes are user-defined, but the use of SIC (standard industry codes) codes is recommended. These codes are specified at job level only.

Inventory Management

Inventory Management is used for issuing physical stock on an ad hoc basis.

Job

The top level of the job hierarchy.

A job can have up to three levels of detail. The first level (the job or main job) is mandatory. The second (sub-job) and third (task) levels are optional, and can be used for more detailed analysis and control. This structure of job levels is called the hierarchy.

Job Detail

A job can have up to three levels of detail. The first level (the job or main job) is mandatory. The second (sub-job) and third (task) levels are optional, and can be used for more detailed analysis and control. This structure of job levels is called the hierarchy.

Job Type

Each job requires a job type to be entered that dictates how the system processes the job, for example the valid expense codes for this job type, or any default text that is to appear on invoices.

Job types are specified at job level, and are used in Job Management:

To enable analysis on jobs by like type for example software projects, construction, manufacturing contracts and so on.

To set defaults for credit checking, income deferral, and so on.

To set default text to appear on invoices.

To identify valid expense types.

A job will be set to 99 for job types defined as closing automatically after the first invoice has been created.

Labour

On the company profile you are required to enter an expense type for timesheets and one for expenses. Every transaction must have an expense type.

Transactions whose expense type is the timesheet expense type are sometimes referred to as labour transactions.

Location

Location codes specify the location of the employee who will carry out work against jobs, and/or the location where the work is taking place. A location is specified at job detail level, and at employee level.

Manager

A manager code can be for either a project manager or an account manager. The project manager is associated with any reviews, i.e. chargeable transaction reviews and invoice reviews. A manager is specified at job detail level.

Masking

This term refers to the method of specifying individual character strings to take the place of existing codes in the creation of General Ledger posting accounts.

Non-chargeable

Every job detail must have a price type defined to it. There are three price types, fixed price, time and materials, and non-chargeable. Non-chargeable job details cannot have invoices generated for them.

Order Entry

Job Management can interface with Inventory Management to capture the cost of Inventory items. Job Management captures the necessary costs by defining a list of parts needed for a job detail. It interacts with Advanced Order Entry or Sales Order Processing to define the parts list.

Sales Order Processing progresses the list of parts, defined as an order, from entry through to despatch. This facilitates the production of acknowledgements, pick notes and clean despatch notes for the parts list. Because the invoices are produced within Job Management, confirmation of despatch prevents the creation of an invoice - instead the inventory costs are posted to Job Management. Each job detail (that is, any job/sub-job/task number) may be assigned to one sales order.

Parts List

A list of the Inventory items required as an element of the cost associated with a job detail. The items entered can be purchased or manufactured, discrete parts or kits.

Penalty Clause

Specified at job level. Penalty clause codes are used within Job Management to identify those jobs which are subject to penalty clauses. They are used for memo purposes only.

Picking Note

A list of stocked items to be picked from the stockroom.

Price Type

Every job detail must have a price type. There are three price types:

Fixed price

Non-chargeable

Time and materials.

This code can be used in building a GL account for income transactions.

Process Code

Certain predefined processes, invoicing for example, can be set to change a job details status code automatically to a user-specified value when the process takes place.

Process codes cannot be used unless the Auto Process Codes field is switched on the company profile.

The following process codes are system defined:

IVD - Invoiced

PDS - Partial despatch

RCV - Goods received

RTN - Return generated

SOC - Sales order created

TDS - Total despatch.

Each job detail has a status code, which can be anything from 01 (open) to 99 (closed). This option enables you to change the status code of a job detail automatically, depending on the processing stage it has reached. This option is where you specify the status code to which the job details are to be set when the relevant process is performed.

Production

A collective term for the JBA modules which enable you to plan, control and cost manufacturing, process and repetitive production methods.

Profit Centre

Profit centres let you analyse costs and income by profit/cost centre across jobs. They are specified at job detail and at employee level.

Purchase Management

Purchase Management accumulates the value of outstanding purchase orders, with matching job numbers, against each job level. You can use Purchase Management to display the outstanding orders for a job.

Quotation

Estimated costs can be built up using the standard functions including parts lists and user-defined expenses. Mark-up percentages can be adjusted to compare different proposed selling prices. The quotation can be converted to a live job, with a facility to use the estimated costs as budgets.

Rate Category

A timesheet or expense has a job detail and an employee. The job detail has the rate code defined in this field, and the employee has a grade defined. Each employee grade has a rate entered for each of the rate categories (A - H), so the combination of job detail and employee enables the system to find the correct rate to apply.

Region

Regions identify the region responsible for carrying out work on jobs. Specified at job detail level only.

Retention Type

Retention codes are used in conjunction with stage payments in Job Management to highlight any contractual agreements regarding payments. They are specified at job detail level only, and are used for memo purposes.

Sales Order Processing

Job Management can interface with Inventory Management to capture the cost of inventory items. Job Management captures the necessary costs by defining a list of parts needed for a job detail. It interacts with Advanced Order Entry or Sales Order Processing to define the parts list.

Sales Order Processing progresses the list of parts, defined as an order, from entry through to despatch. This facilitates the production of acknowledgements, pick notes and clean despatch notes for the parts list. Because the invoices are produced within Job Management, confirmation of despatch prevents the creation of an invoice – instead the inventory costs are posted to Job Management. Each job detail (i.e. any job/sub-job/task number) may be assigned to one sales order.

Secondary Analysis Code

Also known as analysis code.

Within Job Management, you can record up to eight analysis codes against a job, enabling flexible analysis across jobs.

Serial-Controlled

An item defined within Inventory Management as being serial-controlled must have a unique serial number assigned to each individual item in stock.

Service Management

Job Management can automatically generate installation records within Service Management, and can provide access to Service Management to attach the installation to a contract.

Stage Payment

Any fixed price job detail has payments made in stages. Stage payments cannot be made for either of the other two price types (non-chargeable and time and materials).

When the date assigned to the payment is reached, the payment is made. A stage payment can depend on the completion of a number of activities, or on the arrival at a payment date.

Standing Cost

Standing costs simplify the posting of costs against a job number, where the cost could be deemed regular or standard. For instance, rent of machinery could be a standard cost with a fixed currency, an expense type, a transaction type and charge code.

Instead of entering these details in the direct transactions option, you can choose the standing reference and enter the amount. Each standing reference has an associated set of job-numbers (i.e. job/sub-job/task). Reversible standing costs can also be set up to deal with periodic accruals.

Status Code

Each job has a status code which, apart from the two module-defined codes, are user-defined. This enables you to monitor the progress on jobs using your own criteria, for example, completion status, milestones etc. Thus a status code 25 could represent 25% Complete, while 32 could represent Preliminary Site Visit.

The following status codes are reserved by the system for its own use:

01 - Job opened.

99 - Job closed.

Any codes set up by you are considered as open, so costs and income can be entered against any job level as long as it has not been set to level 99.

Each job level initially defaults to a status code of 01 and remains open until set to status 99. You can close off jobs at any level when you want.

Sub-job

A job can have up to three levels of detail. The first level (the job or main job) is mandatory. The second (sub-job) and third (task) levels are optional, and can be used for more detailed analysis and control. This structure of job levels is called the hierarchy.

Task

A job can have up to three levels of detail. The first level (the job or main job) is mandatory. The second (sub-job) and third (task) levels are optional, and can be used for more detailed analysis and control. This structure of job levels is called the hierarchy.

Time and Materials

Also known as T&M. Every job detail must have a price type defined to it. There are three price types: fixed price, time and materials, and non-chargeable

Invoices can be generated for T&M job details, calculated according to labour and expense costs, materials costs, and mark-up percentages.

Timesheet

Although many organisations enter timesheet data on a weekly / monthly cycle, it is possible to record the entries on a daily basis, with a periodic update of the job costs. The data recorded is used to update actual labour costs on both chargeable and non-chargeable jobs, and calculate invoice values on T&M jobs. Timesheets can be reviewed and amended before posting.

Transaction Source

When you create a new Job Management company the system creates some transaction sources, which prefix Job Management transaction numbers. The codes identify the originating source of transactions logged against a job:

IM - Inventory movement

SC - Standing cost

SR - Standing cost reversal

JM - Job Management

PL - Purchase Ledger (Accounts Payable)

These codes arrive in GL suffixed by the document reference number. GL then prefixes the whole with J, to indicate that the transaction is from Job Management.

When transferring the transaction within GL - for example from work in progress to profit and loss - the initial J is kept, but the transaction source is changed:

IM, JM and PL become RC

SC and SR become RS

RI - Release of income.

These transaction sources, once in GL, are called transaction types.

If the transaction source is from an associated module such as Accounts Payable or Inventory Management, then the source code will be pre-set to the ID of that module.

Transaction Type

These are specified at transaction level. Transaction types are used to further identify transactions within a job in addition to transaction source.

These transactions are defined by you. As a minimum, transaction types must be set up for any employee expenses, timesheet and Inventory transactions.

All timesheets and employee expense sheet functions must have an associated expense type and transaction type. Similarly, inventory movements via the Inventory Management interface must have a unique expense type, transaction type and charge code.

Transfer Method

Every job detail must have a transfer method to specify how its costs and income are to be posted from the General Ledger WIP account into Fixed Assets or a profit and loss account.

There are 9 transfer methods, from 0 to 8:

0 - Costs will not be posted to WIP, they will be posted directly to P&L.

Income posted to job details with transfer method 0 will be treated as follows:

If the job is time and material, the cost has been posted directly to P&L, then it follows that the income cannot go to balance sheet even if the job type is defined as deferred income.

If the job is fixed price, the costs will go directly to P&L, but the income could be in the balance sheet if the income was deferred.

1 - Initially, costs are posted to WIP.

Costs are transferred from WIP to P&L.

Transfer of costs from WIP to P&L happens for all 1 job details when you initiate the transfer to P&L.

2 - Initially, costs are posted to WIP.

Costs are transferred from WIP to P&L.

Control of which costs and / or income are to be released from WIP to P&L happens via the Release Jobs option.

3 - Initially, costs are posted to WIP.

Costs are transferred from WIP to P&L.

Release of costs from WIP to P&L happens via the Release Jobs option, but the job detail must be closed at the same time.

4 - Initially, costs are posted to WIP.

Costs are transferred from WIP to Fixed Assets.

Release of costs from WIP to Fixed Assets happens for all 4 job details when you initiate a batch process.

5 - Initially, costs are posted to WIP.

Costs are transferred from WIP to Fixed Assets.

Release of costs from WIP to Fixed Assets happens via the Release Jobs option.

6 - Initially, costs are posted to WIP.

Costs are transferred from WIP to Fixed Assets.

Release of costs from WIP to Fixed Assets happens via the Release Jobs option, but the job detail must be closed at the same time.

7 - Initially, costs are posted to WIP.

Costs are held in WIP, and are not transferable to P&L or Fixed Assets.

8 - Initially, costs are posted to WIP.

Release of costs from WIP to Fixed Assets or to P&L happens via the Invoicing / Asset Generation option. The decision as to whether an item is revenue or capital does not have to be made until this option is taken.

T&M

Also known as time and materials. Every job detail must have a price type defined to it. There are three price types: fixed price, time and materials, and non-chargeable

Invoices can be generated for T&M job details, calculated according to labour and expense costs, materials costs, and mark-up percentages.

Uplift Code

Specified at timesheet level. Uplift codes are only used for timesheet entries. The cost of labour time may depend on varying factors such as shifts, overtime, etc. Uplift codes will recalculate the cost of labour using the formula:

uplift code value * no of hours * hourly rate

for an employee in the base currency.

Therefore if uplift code X=1.5, then the cost of labour will be multiplied by 1.5 for all timesheet lines with an uplift code of X.

Variation Reason Code

When you change, at job detail level, a budget, a selling price, or the estimated hours, the system will ask you to enter a variation reason.

WIP

Also known as work in progress.

Within Job Management, WIP refers to the General Ledger WIP balance sheet account to which all Job Management costs are posted before being transferred to Fixed Assets or a profit and loss account.

Work in Progress

Also known as WIP.

Within Job Management, work in progress refers to the General Ledger work in progress balance sheet account to which all Job Management costs are posted before being transferred to Fixed Assets or a profit and loss account.

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